The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe
C. S. Lewis

Chapters 1–2

Characters, Setting and Atmosphere

Learning objectives

1. Identify the main characters and their personalities.
2. Explore the setting and atmosphere of the story.
3. Explain how the writer creates mystery.
4. Use evidence from the text to support answers.
5. Make predictions about what might happen next.

Chapter 1: Lucy goes into the wardrobe

1. Why were the four children sent to live in the countryside?

They were evacuated from London because of the air raids during World War II.

2. Who is the Professor?

Professor Kirke is an elderly man who allows the children to stay in his large country house.

3. What are the names of the four children?

Peter, Susan, Edmund and Lucy.4.

Who is the youngest?

Lucy is the youngest.

4. Why do the children decide to explore the house?

Because it is raining outside, they decide to explore the rooms of the house.

Character development: The four children

Character	Animal mentioned	Possible personality traits
Peter	Hawks	Strong, confident, adventurous
Lucy	Badgers	Loyal, friendly, determined
Edmund	Foxes	Cunning, sly, mischievous
Susan	Rabbits	Gentle, cautious, sensible

Character analysis: Find the evidence

How does C. S. Lewis reveal the personalities of the four children?

Look at Chapter 1 and find evidence of the following characteristics:

- Peter – adventurous and confident
- Susan – practical and sensible
- Edmund – negative and unfriendly
- Lucy – curious and courageous

Setting: The Professor's mysterious house



How does the author describe the Professor's house?



The house is:

Very large and old.

Full of long passages and many rooms.

Filled with unusual objects and places to explore.

Unfamiliar and slightly mysterious.

Questions

1. **What impression do you get of the house?**

The house seems interesting, mysterious and full of possibilities.

2. **Why might the house seem frightening?**

Its size, empty rooms and unfamiliar passages create uncertainty because the children do not know what they might discover.

3. **How does the setting prepare us for Lucy's discovery?**

The unusual setting prepares the reader for the possibility of something unexpected or magical.

Prediction: What is inside the wardrobe?

- What do you think Lucy will find inside?
- What would you do if you were Lucy?
- What feelings might Lucy experience?
- Why might the author use a wardrobe as the entrance to another world?



What does Lucy discover inside the wardrobe?

- As Lucy walks further inside:
- The fur coats give way to tree branches.
- The floor becomes cold and covered in snow.
- She finds herself in a snowy forest.
- She notices a lamppost.
- She encounters a strange creature.

Questions

1. How does the setting change?

The setting changes from a familiar, ordinary wardrobe into an unfamiliar snowy forest.

2. Which details appeal to the reader's senses?

Touch: the cold snow and tree branches.

Sight: the forest and lamppost.

3. How does Lewis make this moment surprising?

The gradual transformation creates suspense. Readers discover the unusual world at the same time as Lucy.



Chapter 1 Summary

- The four children leave London because _____.
- They stay in the house of _____.
- They explore the house because _____.
- Lucy discovers _____ inside the wardrobe.
- At the end of the chapter, she meets _____.







Chapter 2: What Lucy Found There

Who is Mr Tumnus?

A faun: a mythical creature with a human upper body and goat-like legs.

One of the first creatures Lucy meets in Narnia.

Initially appears polite, friendly and welcoming.

Invites Lucy to his home for tea.

Questions

1. How does Mr Tumnus react when he meets Lucy?

He is surprised to meet a human because he does not expect to encounter one.

2. What does he call Lucy?

He calls her a "Daughter of Eve", meaning a human girl.

3. Why does Lucy trust him?

He behaves politely and kindly, making Lucy feel comfortable.





What happens in Chapter 2?

- Mr Tumnus invites Lucy to his cave for tea.
- He entertains her with stories and music.
- He becomes upset and begins to cry.
- He admits that he works for the White Witch.
- He was supposed to capture any human he discovered.
- He decides to help Lucy escape.

Questions

Why does Mr Tumnus begin to cry?

He feels guilty because he has gained Lucy's trust while secretly intending to betray her.

2. What was he supposed to do with Lucy?

He was supposed to capture her and hand her over to the White Witch.

3. Why does he change his mind?

He realizes that betraying Lucy would be cruel and wrong.

The White Witch's power over Narnia
"Always winter and never Christmas."

1. **What does winter usually suggest?**

Winter may suggest coldness, hardship, darkness and discomfort.

2**. What feelings do we associate with Christmas?**

Christmas is associated with celebration, warmth, joy and hope.

3. Why is this description effective?

The contrast suggests that Narnia has lost happiness and hope because of the White Witch's power.

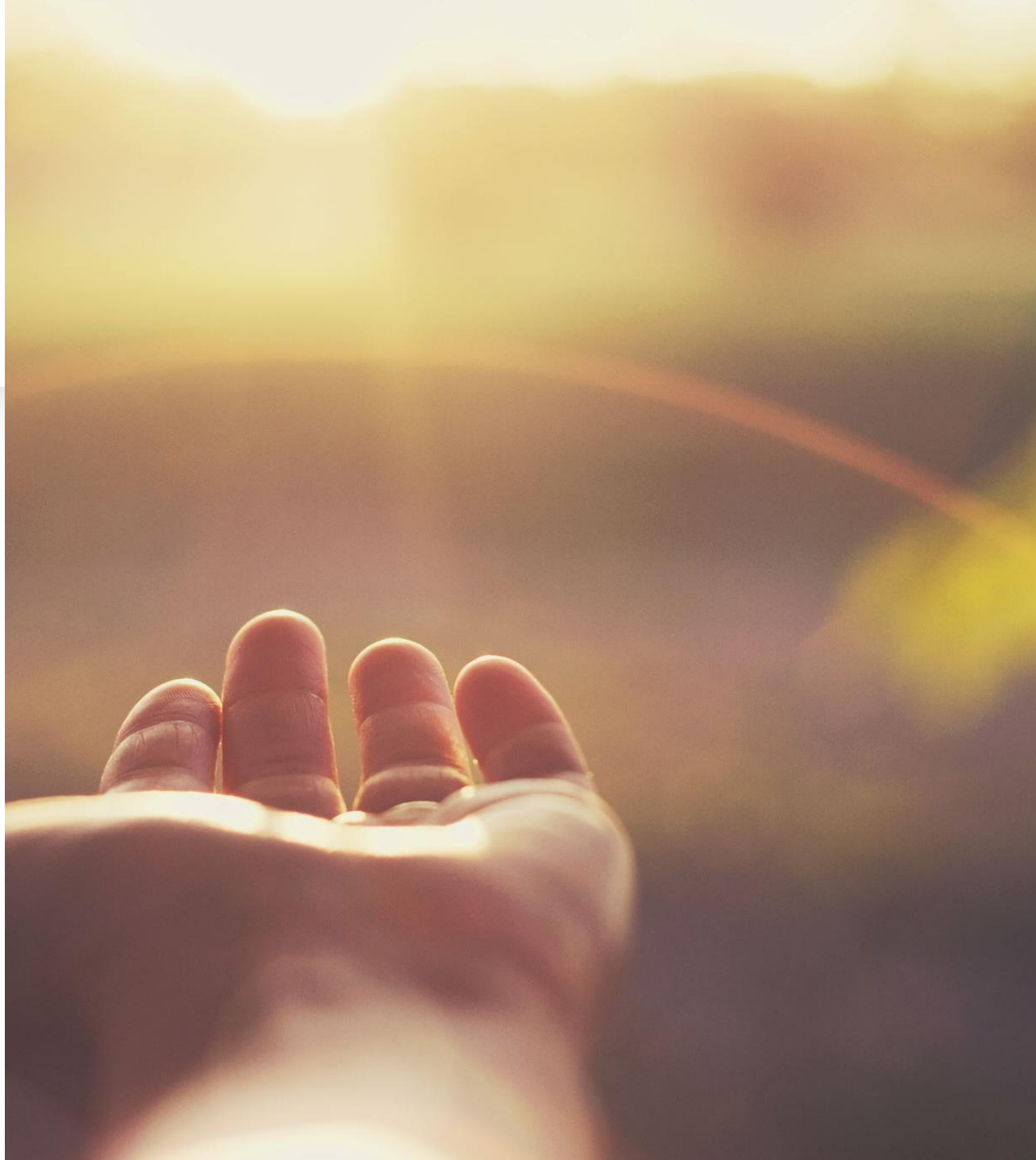
4. What impression do we get of the White Witch?

She appears cruel, powerful and controlling.



Vocabulary

- Find these words in the chapter:
  - Melancholy
  - Treachery
  - Lulling
  - Mantelpiece
  - Reigns



The writer's choice of language

"Always winter and never Christmas."

- Creates a cold, gloomy and hopeless atmosphere.
- Makes readers understand the suffering caused by the Witch.
- Suggests that happiness and celebration have disappeared.

The warm, comfortable cave of Mr Tumnus.

- Creates a warm, welcoming and comfortable atmosphere.
- Makes readers initially feel that Lucy is safe.
- Contrasts with the cold and threatening world outside.

Food for thought...

Do you think Lucy was right to trust Mr Tumnus? Explain.

Was Mr Tumnus brave to help Lucy escape?

What do you think will happen if the White Witch discovers what he has done?

What do you predict will happen in Chapters 3 and 4?

HOMEWORK



Write a short summary of each chapter in your notebook (approximately 4–5 sentences per chapter).



Use your summary notebook.



Due on Friday 23 /10 /26.



Read Chapters 3 and 4 in preparation for the next lesson.